

Public History Course First Day

Negative: experiments with stuff, doesn't work. Sarcastic. 100% history majors.

Soft Deadline: Do when wanted.

Final reflections, project work.

Squishy: May affect other assignments if done late.

Readings, reflections, assignment discussions

Hard: Must turn in.

Self-assessments, project progress, project, ePortfolio

Pre-reading

First Article

- People are living in the context of their history. They act and make decisions based on cultures, traditions, and religions that have all touched History (capital H) at one point or another.
- Understanding the linkage between past and present is essential for making good decisions. Text talks about those who live rootless (absent historical context) live rootless lives that cause damage to themselves and others. People with complete memory loss cannot manage their own at all.
- “All living people live in the here-and-now but it took a long unfolding history to get everything to NOW.”
- “It’s useless” is a flawed view of an immediate utility formula. Education isn’t about learning specific tasks, it is about mastery of a topic including its development. It’s dumb to say people shouldn’t learn Economics if they’re not going to run a bank, or that learning genetics is dumb if they don’t plan to clone an animal.
- “It’s basic and boring” is also incorrect and likely comes from bad experiences with history teachers focused on pedagogic styles of teaching (memorization). This type of learning is meaningless because you can’t “comprehend 20th-century world history if given nothing but a list of key dates.” **Therefore, history is not just learning dates.**
- Each discipline has its own history. Law has precedents that have been developed by courts throughout its history. The politics of today have been crafted by the politics of yesterday. Everything is *specialized* history, but History is the study of the whole human experience.
- “the synchronic is always in the diachronic” (The immediate is always in the past)
- Living creatures have an instinctive synchro-mesh where they only consider the here and now. The human advantage is that we can look to the diachro-mesh, the past, to avoid mistakes.
- Without cultivating this ability, people will rely on other (less reliable) forms.

Second Article

- Historians typically work within their small societies. “Public historians are interested in the ways in which the past is present in people’s lives”
- Some public historians aim at impartiality while others are willing to get messy. History is inherently political because life is political.

- Thomas Cauvin's Public History: "Public history has at its core, a consideration for popular non-academic audiences." Don't think of it as a separate field but as part of the job. He is a sound methodology and rigorous objectivity guy. "It is necessary to stress that historians' activism is controversial since it is often based on their personal convictions."
- Lyon, Nix, and Shrum's Introduction to Public History: "History that people encounter outside the classroom and beyond the traditional history text" and is set apart by its audience. They espouse a progressive public history, but that leave the contradictory opinions to the audience: "The best public history professionals adeptly address the most pressing concerns of these complex and sometimes contradictory opinions to produce an end product that will appeal to multiple, diverse audiences."
- What about when dealing with human rights violations?
 - LNS calls for "a reflective practice that does not stop at thinking carefully about what we do, but goes beyond to pondering on the why." Examine as historians and social beings.
- In the U.S., public history is very hesitant to engage in civic engagements and in intervening in contemporary issues. This is because we're not dealing with genocides, but more nuanced topics in contemporary life.
- Public history is not in the margins, but at the core of historiography. Jannelle Warren-Findley links changing theories of history to public history practice.
- Questions at the end:
 - Who is entitled to produce history and why?
 - What histories are legitimate?
 - What is the significance of our work?
 - What do we do it for and for whom?
 - What is the public history our communities need?
 - What is the public history our globalized world—facing challenges from the crisis of democracy to global warming—needs?

"The argument is inherent in the presentation."

Dahlongega "The Lost Cause"

Pre-reading

1. What is Andrew's argument about the role of military schools?
 - a. "The southern states did not introduce military discipline into the land-grant colleges solely to honor their Confederate past. There were other practical, economic, and egalitarian reasons for imitating West Point, VMI, and the Citadel."
 - b. The Lost Cause, combined with flaws of the Morrill Act, created an environment that was susceptible to Confederate appreciation. The roots of viewing young cadets as naturally heroic in the South has origins from the Confederacy. Students in the North rebelled against military instruction requirements by calling it not patriotic. Students in the South rarely did so because they saw it as patriotic, heroic, and virtuous.
2. How does UNG fit in?
 - a. We have an uncomfortable history of being a land-grant college that overly adapted military instruction into our school, that fostered a comfortable environment for Confederate praise.
 - b. UNG was a co-ed from the beginning, it is important to look towards how revolutionary was this school was as opposed to other land-grant schools.
3. (How) does (or not) this essay make you reconsider UNG?
 - a. With optimism, I like to believe that although the view that military instruction produces virtuous students started through unfortunate roots, it continues today with more simplistic causes. Today, it seems more possible to argue that being a cadet doesn't automatically make a person virtuous or patriotic.

The Museum of Appalachia and the Invention of an Idyllic Past

1. What is the role of nostalgia in this article?
 - a. Nostalgia sometimes has an effect where the person reminiscing on a memory or thought of the past will have a picturesque view instead of a true recollection of the past. Nobody enjoys remembering the bad times, but we yearn for the good times. Many of the museums that are discussed in this article are just creations of nostalgia, which doesn't frame the precise past but more so a perfected version of it.
2. What is Larsen's argument about the purpose of some of the museums he examines?

- a. Larsen argues that the museums cater to the “portrayal of the past in such pastoral terms, evoking the open and controlled garden environment that traditionally has signified both mankind’s desire to dominate nature, as well as his quest to reintegrate the human and the natural in a balanced Edenic coexistence.”
 - b. “the Museum of Appalachia narrative inadvertently transforms history by what is included and what is left out, how the exhibits are spatially and visually composed, and by the kinds of information that the visitor is given”
 - c. “Escapist,” “Escape from modernity [...] but also from history itself,” and that it’s a “sentimentalist approach to history.” It's more concerned with the goal of presenting something different than something truthful.
3. What does Larsen argue is left out of the Museum of Appalachia?
 - a. Federal subsidies by the Tennessee Valley Authority, which would combat the “independent mountaineers” narrative of the museum. Poverty, disease, and general ailments that affected the population in this time period. Also missing is African American workers. Geographic isolation by bad terrain.
4. What is/how is authenticity used in this article?
 - a. Andrew espouses the argument by MacCannell that authenticity, while important, can be sacrificed to make history more appealing to tourists as long as there is a clear cut between what is fiction and reality. The tourist has the duty of envisioning the authentic, and the exhibit is just the stepping stone. To bring true authenticity to the tourist will sacrifice either appealability or ease. Therefore, true authenticity is impossible.
 - b. “With his museum John Rice Irwin has created a world of simplicity and perceived authenticity that serves as a counter narrative to the modern, and, albeit an illusion, it is one which most visitors want to believe in because it signifies that there is something real left after all.”

Class Notes

When do traditions become traditions? - Public Historians

Dichotomy of good/bad don’t work.

Nationalism can be either inclusive (you’re in this country so you’re with us) or exclusive (you’re not one of us, get out).

Public History: Who should be uncomfortable? How do we make them uncomfortable?

- Exclusion and Inclusion can make uncomfortable.

Pre-reading

Smith:

- Heritage is a process of engagement and of communication.
- Storytelling: generation to generation. Meanings will change.
- Heritage is also about the role it plays on the present.
- Self-regulated but dissonant discourse.
- Major quote:
 - “[Heritage] may, for instance, be about reworking the meanings of the past as the cultural, social, and political needs of the present change or develop, or it may be about challenging the ways in which groups and communities are perceived and classified by others.”
- Heritage is a negotiation between communities, and inside those communities.
- How we frame heritage is discourse. Current Western way is to praise “things” typically nation-related.

Graham, et al:

- Authors believe heritage is losing its meaning because of changing interpretations.
- Heritage: a view from the present either backward to a past or forward to a future. Contemporary use of the past, mostly.

Class Discussion

What does Smith mean when she says history is usable?

- Heritage is used to inform and change our decisions of the present.

Heritage is a process?

- Stories are passed down and the interpretation of those stories is part of the process. It is ever-evolving.

Heritage is a discourse?

- How we present and save it is a discourse itself. It organizes how we act in light of the heritage we learn.

How do Graham, et al define Heritage?

- The present is the creator of heritage. Heritage is the meanings we attach to the past, which we use for contemporary purposes.

Pre-reading Notes

Pierre Nora Article

- History is accelerating and we are seeing societies which have future-proofed their teachings get lost, as well as ideologies that focused on the smooth handling of the future get disappeared. The ideas of enlightenment, forgotten.
- Memory is held by communities and is always changing, characterized by remembering and forgetting, and is also a victim of time's erosion. Sometimes, it is intentionally tampered with to give us *Geschichte* (which translates to story). History is the attempted reconstruction of the **PAST** (not memory).
- "Every great historical revision has sought to enlarge the basis for collective memory."
- **Memory-nation** (or national heritage) is the last incarnation of the unification of memory and history. History, as a discipline, has turned into a social science of methodological approach with historiography as the weapon.
- **Memory-history**: reading history through the lenses of Nora's "memory," or the ability to consider the "life" of a historical argument and its ties to the present.
- **Archive-memory**: preserving records to pull from later, which Nora associates with the draining of Memory-history from society which leads to people seeking to archive everything because nothing is archived naturally for them.
 - "*Lieux de memoire* originate with the sense that there is no spontaneous memory, that we must deliberately create archives [...] because such activities no longer occur naturally."
- **Duty-memory**: memory transformed by its passage through history with zero emotional backing or memories, or frankly History as a discipline with its respect to historiography.
- **Distance-memory**: viewing the past through the differences of the present.
 - "No longer a retrospective continuity but the illumination of discontinuity."
 - "Paradoxically, distance demands the rapprochement that negates it while giving it resonance."
 - "Our relation to the past is now formed in a subtle play between its intractability and its disappearance..."

Someone can go to the lieux de memoire but not be part of the environment because of how they experience it. We see Price Memorial as Price Memorial but the environment sees it as a gold mine. Individual memory, collective memory, and History.

What we know, what the group knows, and what is actually.

1. Consider Nora's argument about the relationship of memory and history on p8-9. How does it work or not work for you?
 - a. Nora frames the relationship of memory as history similar to our discussion between the AHD and "unauthorized" historical discourse. Heritage is memory of the past to the group remembering it and so it is responsive to censorship or "unauthorization" while History is methodologically bound to historiography which seeks to procure "true" memory, which "enlarge the basis for a collective memory."
2. What are his lieux de memoire?
 - a. Physical sites of historical significance that are made because society turns its back on memory, as Nora understands it. "If history did not besiege memory, deforming and transforming it, penetrating and petrifying it, there would be no *lieux de memoire*."
3. What do you make of Nora's ideas from p 13: "What we take to be flare-ups of memory are in fact its final consumption in the flames of history. The quest for memory is the search for one's history."
 - a. Nora points that today's memory is like looking at a building from the exterior scaffolding and outward signs, purely archival and distant. I think it's important to note what is being archived today, and it's the personals of everyone. Nora even acknowledges this, noting that main archivists in the past were "great families, the church, and the state" but today it is anyone.
4. On p. 13, do you agree with his assessment of modern memory? Why? Why not?
 - a. I disagree immensely and even Nora works against his point. History archival as a practice is no different in this era as to others, except with the added caveat that *everyone* is archiving because they have the newfound ability to do so. They are archiving their thoughts, their lives, and their stories. Each archival is its own *Geschichte* and serves even to Nora's definition of memory, as an extension of heritage.
5. What is "distance-memory" to Nora? P. 16
 - a. Viewing the past through the illumination of the discontinuity (or differences) of the present. It's different from archival-history because it doesn't rely on

attempts to bring the past back, but instead of looking at the differences that we can't bring back.

Talking History Podcast

1. How does Kohn's idea of the Old Towns illustrate (or not) Nora's ideas?
 - a. The stories of the old town are ones about the nation. The old towns of Poland told stories of the Nazi occupation of Poland, and avoiding putting itself under the regime of the Soviet Union – it was a story of Polish national identity. Even the reconstruction of the Polish old town is a symbolic triumph of Polish identity after destruction during the war.
 - b. Nora is a French historian discussing the identity of the *lieux de mémoire* sites in France and the French identity that comes with it. His article talks about the critical handling of French historical “objects” in a scientific historiography approach, which guts the memory from the object.

“Pre-reading”

How are archives sites of violence or contestation?

The state having an “authorized heritage discourse” can serve political purpose to pacify opponents, diversify national economies, and monumentalize state power. Because of this, they have an interest in defending these sites and have employed state power to police knowledge production and crush domestic opposition, all while historians are left as detectives trying to find the remains of “unauthorized heritage discourse.”

Saudi Arabia employed mass arrest against domestic opposition on these issues.

U.S. Armed Forces refused to safeguard Iraqi cultural properties, meanwhile looting the archives to the United States. Reports came in that they were actively encouraging these acts. Researchers say the United States stole 89% of the past regime’s archives in the first few months of occupation.

“Universal neglect of a tax against heritage”

What are the politics of public history and written/physical history?

Wow, the government sucks.

War, sanctions, and state-violence perpetrate the state’s ability to dictate and control the authorized heritage discourse because “unauthorized” heritage discourse’s material history gets looted, destroyed, and jeopardized in times of crisis.

“[Saudi Arabia’s state-sponsored AHD] necessarily relied on the simultaneous mass destruction of historical as well as sacred space across the country, space that countered official Saudi history.

Anti-war domestic opposition exposed the Saudi’s political, military, and economic weakness. The regime responded by historical revisionism, weaponizing the archives to territorialize history and pacify opposition. The United States was a core conspirator in these efforts in Saudi Arabia, as well as international media outlets who legitimized these authorized heritage discourses.

Conclusion: The modern state requires the ability to “authorize” and “unauthorize” heritage discourse.

Class Notes

Friday, Room 382 of the Library (Special Collections Department)

History is a dispute of interpretations, not truth. Don't use "truth" in a history class.

More regulated history, less accurate but more accepted.

Less regulated history, more accurate but less accepted.

Institutions change: FBI told MLK Jr. to kill himself but now praises him. Institutions are made of people.

Never look at the local history as the local history.

Accept and acknowledge.

"Are we constructing history where it doesn't exist?"

Ascribing infallibility or intent to the CIA is... not smart. You can assign influence to a power structure, but intent needs to have a human responsible.

History in the modern sense: we don't have access to the archives behind the door.

Wednesday will be the politics of archiving and the politics of "all of this."

Pre-listening Notes

What are theories?

- Foucault: The boundaries of what can be said for the past.
 - Worked to make archive a metaphor, which spun off the rest.
- Derrida: Science of archive involving memory, suppression, death drive – “the fear of cultural loss.”
- Julietta Singh: The body as an archive, what the past “deposits” in us: pain, sex, race, etc.
- Society of American Archivists: Permanently valuable records of documentable history.
- Ernst: “The power of memory lies less in the past than in its undeceivable storage.”

How do we use archives?

- Ann Laura Stoler: Reading with the archival brain and classify them in how they repose now.
 - Example of the author that an archivist wanted to “re-classify” George Eliot’s work from a poetic but instead a novelist.
- Weld is confronted with a large undiscovered Guatemalan archive but doesn’t dive into it at first, instead takes a step back and assesses the political and sociological ramifications of the archive itself.
 - How do archives produced by the state and the society compare?
 - Before diving into archives of the police, what is the history of the police?
- Guatemalan archive led to prosecutions of past leaders, resolution of mystery of past regimes through documentaries and public materials, etc.
- Guatemalan “archivists” weren’t formally educated but had “memory” of the Guatemala. They wanted to take the archive to court immediately, but trained archivists proceeded their process.
- Everyone is making archives: police, trainers, military, etc. It’s seen as boring, but it’s where everything is archive. Archives can make or break governments: tools of social composition.
- Final report by the on-the-ground archivist was censored by the state (in our view, inspector general) and used as a bargaining chip. The archive, again, used for political purposes.

How does ‘what is known’ skew ‘how we know it’?

- #ArchivesAreNotNeutral
- The United States trained and worked with the Guatemalan police to develop its archive abilities as a tool of domestic suppression of local opposition. We look at the archive “what is known” as a record of abuse, the state looks at it as a weapon.
- Archives are “inherently political.” There are things that are “known” that some people don’t want to “know” (government censorship) and so the handling of these records, the creation, and the distribution thereof is a political process. Speaking of archives is political.

Class Notes

- Dahlonga Research Thing
- There is a linguistic language issue in some archives.
- Archives are a “human-mediated” process. There is an archive in America and an archive in Latin America.
- “How does an archive serve as a memory site?”
- “How do the UNG archives act? What are the biases of the archive? Where are the holes?”
 - Don’t throw something away as biased, engage and assess the bias in your review.
 - Turn it into a question: how does it address something? How do we access it? Is the language problematic?
 - Will the Lost Cause be difficult or easier to find?

Class Preparation

DC-21: Anne Amerson Collection

DC-23: James Longstreet Collection

- Lost Cause evidence

DC-11: George Gordon Collection

How do we know who does what to the archives? Sign-in sheet?

- T

Class Notes

Allison

Monday, in Dunlap

Wednesday and Friday, in Library

- You can do a search of just special collection and archives in [gilFIND](#).

Types of dates:

- Inclusive dates:

Please do not reorganize the folder, at all. If mistake found, alert but don't fix. Do not remove rusty staples or issues, alert the archivist.

Metadata is important for historical citations.

Training in paleography.

Libguide for the class as US-focused Public History/Archives papers. Library stuff is in ERIC, which is more librarian focused.

Reparative Archiving. Archivists decided long ago that they were neutral participants in the collection of documents, is now reconsidering itself and its place in archiving.

William Pierce, congressman speeches.

Digital Library of Georgia is for Georgia-specific stuff.

Digital Public Library of America is American-wide.

For Monday—

Think of the grading rubric for the class.

Politics of Public History – (02/03/2025)

Include notes in e-Portfolio. It is the evidence of the development of learning objectives.
The goal is to demonstrate progression.

Politics of Public History – (02/05/2025)

General James Longstreet:

- Appointed Brevet Second Lieutenant – July 1st, 1842 – by John Tyler
- Appointed Second Lieutenant of Eighth Regiment of Infantry – March 4th, 1845 – by James K Polk.
- Appointed First Lieutenant of the above position – February, 23rd, 1847 – by James K Polk.
- Appointed **BATTLE** Captain – August 20th, 1847 – by James K. Polk
- Appointed **BATTLE** Major – September 8th, 1847 – by James K. Polk. Polk writes that the appointment was “for gallant and meritorious conduct in the battle of “Molino del Rey.”
- Appointed **ACTUAL** Captain – December 7th, 1852 – by Franklin Pierce
- Appointed Paymaster – July 19th, 1858 – by James Buchanan

CIVIL WAR HAPPENS

- Appointed Surveyor of Customs for the Port of New Orleans in the State of Louisiana – April 3rd, 1869 – by Ulysses S. Grant
- Appointed IRS Agent – September 7th, 1878 – by Green B. Raum ***
 - **Raise from \$6.00 to \$7.00/day**
- Appointed Gainesville Postmaster – January 16th, 1879 – by Rutherford B. Hayes
- Appointed Minister Resident to Turkey – June 14th, 1880 – by Rutherford B. Hayes
 - What is he doing there? It's not Turkey in 1880.
- Appointed U.S. Marshal to Georgia – May 10th, 1881 – by James A. Garfield
- Appointed Alternate Commissioner to the Commission to celebrate the 400th anniversary of the discovery of America by Christopher Columbus “by holding an International Exhibition of Arts, Industries, Manufactures, and the product of the Soil, Mine, and Sea, in the City of Chicago, in the State of Illinois.”
 - Nominated by the Governor of the State of Georgia
 - Commission created by act of Congress.
 - Appointed by Benjamin Harrison
 - Investigate other commission members.
- **Aztec Club Membership – September 13th, 1885 – by**
- **Rifle Shooting Clubs**

NARA: Price's House

Pre-reading

How are museums texts? What does Reeve mean here?

Like how books are open to different interpretations, museums are texts in that they are just objects communicating things which the viewer must assign an interpretation to.

Reeve's interpretation is a post-modernist one which is that there is not singular interpretation but that it's discourse that is discontinuous and individual-focused.

“Modernist museums have education departments; Post-modernist ones have learning, access and interpretation teams.” – Page 66

The text is the “disembodied voice of the controlling institution” and the amalgamation of various individuals (institutions = individuals) with differing interests, values, and cultures.

Older galleries were uniform in their text and devoid of delight, emotion, and meaning. They were unappealing to users. This is the cube. Some were just dictations from above on what the interpretation is to be. This is the temple.

Museums are now responsive to their users. It's not a temple anymore, nor a cube, but a laboratory.

Does actual text in museums help or hinder learning? There is disagreement. Visitors also appear to be mixed but there is agreement that there are “high expectations of background information.” (74) It appears to depend on the audience.

What should museums be according to Reeve?

Reeve prefers that Museums be laboratory style, not cube and not temple. The objective is learning, not education.

Class Notes

Discussion-specific assignment due Sunday, will discuss on Friday. Actually do the readings.

Museum of the Future in Dubai

Look at ungrading as learning and not education in terms of Reeve. Look at the D2L discussion on ungrading too, including the Whiteboard.

Dahlonaga Gold Museum – Temple

Longstreet Museum – Laboratory

Pre-reading

Why only National Historic Sites?

The root of oral history and historical memory is individual memories and recollections.

Historical Memory: Questions how the individual memory is formed and therefore the recording of it. It also deals with how collective and social memory is formed.

Oral History/Memory: Collecting memory from individuals. Focuses on the narrator and inserting them into the story.

“[T]hose who attempt to ‘rescue’ the memories of less privileged voices are also transforming the memories themselves by altering their social acceptance.” The historian or recorder is empowered to transform how the memories are viewed, therefore you need both oral history and historical memory.

Collective memory is an act of transfer (storytelling, etc) where historical sites are the central location of those transfers.

History is a spectrum where “general history” starts when heritage fades. Heritage sites are the transition phase between heritage and general history.

Curators at Colonial Williamsburg tried making the site more historically accurate but returning guests complained of the change. CW was changing individual memories that shaped the “general history” of how they viewed the past. They were essentially altering national history. – They are powerful weapons of memory.

Dutch History is golden age but not for everyone. Usage of the term skews to the present, maybe they need a story to unite? Netherlands not doing so well?

What is forgotten/lost/ignored in historical sites?

- “Sites of national historic significance can be understood as a national ‘stage’ whereupon collective memories are acted out for a larger audience” – The roles and stories of minorities are omitted in these plays, as was the case in the Fortress of Louisbourg where the plot focuses on the “two founding nations” story.

What is remembered/commemorated?

- “This central ‘national history’ often does not regard different experiences or memories tied to historical events” (¶13) What is often remembered is the authorized history because it’s a really slow process to change history as the public consumes it. It requires changing of memory which can only be done by – according to the first article – inclusion of the unrepresented “other.”

What are ways to think about it?

Museums are powerful weapons in history that can, sometimes inadvertently, deify a historical figure/time period. In the first article, it was to non-marginalized group voices which were put on a pedestal. In the second article, it was to a time period of 17th century Dutch history.

It’s important that museums change how they handle history to let the visitor be the interpreter instead of the museum, who is almost always just going to repeat the authorized narrative because they created the authorized narrative. First article recommends the inclusion of “other” voices, second article recommends letting the visitor be the storyteller.

Class Notes

Sad – Madison’s House, none of the servants were part of the story. In the 90s, they were starting to think about that. Yay, progress!

The contribution that Bos makes that museums are not neutral and actually are weapons of change to history, help put into understanding public history.

“One dude doesn’t do everything, it takes a village – so where is the village?”

Jefferson-Sally

“Museums are fundamentally dangerous – History is dangerous.” If you’re doing it right, someone is going to be unhappy. There’s a reason the national archivist got fired this weekend.

“What does he think is Golden [Age]?”

Politics of Public History -- (02/14/2025)

Next week: guest lecture on Friday. Guest is going to be zooming in.

State Department: Office of the Historian

“Does a museum need to be designated a museum to be a museum?”

Pre-reading

In the East, communism focused on their triumph over fascism. In the West, democracy focused on their triumph over fascism. Communism ignored the Jewish part of the holocaust because they want a nationalized secular political identity.

Holocaust and Fascism is the most recent “evil” for the West but Communism is the most recent “evil” for them.

West refused to acknowledge how they handed the East to Stalin, making the Western memory of the Holocaust unappetizing to the East.

Germany has “Vergangenheitsbewältigung” which is a self-congratulatory view of the Holocaust in how they’ve handled it. Most of the West has some aspect of this, “yay ****we**** stopped the Holocaust” instead of looking at how they got to the Holocaust.

UK refused entry to Jews fleeing from the war, and also deported some to Germany where they were almost certainly killed. There is no mention of this in their memory. Even Italy’s memory is clouded by how Germany was mostly responsible and that Italy was passive compared to them. This hypocrisy is why the Western view of the Holocaust never took off.

In the reconstruction of Europe after, namely in its globalization front, the West softly demanded that the East apologize for its actions during the Holocaust but never did so themselves. This grew Eastern resentment of the Western narrative.

The East wants Stalin to become the Hitler of the cosmopolitan memory, but the West refuses. There is no evil greater than Hitler. They saw some success by teaming with the Western right and framing the memory as “anti-totalitarian”.

“The compromise of ‘European memory unity’ has, therefore, served as a screen memory that covers both the undersirable Holocaust past in the East and the undesirable colonial past in the West.”

“This dialogic relationship between different memory positions in contemporary Europe illuminates ways in which political memory constitutes an instrument of state political legitimacy.” The West wants their narrative of German culpability so they can be the bad guys, the East wants theirs because it’s unfair that they’re the only ones that have to repent for the Holocaust especially after the West handed them to Stalin. The fight of the memory hurts the EU’s legitimacy of shared cultural grounds.

What are the challenges of this type of tourism?

Catering to history tourists depends on the tourist background. Eastern European backgrounds don't like one narrative, Western European backgrounds don't like the other.

"localization of the killing then becomes very destabilizing to Eastern European societies as local perpetration becomes central to the memory of the Holocaust and accounting for it becomes that much more difficult and often strongly resented." (Page 324)

West disregarded the "destruction and civilian suffering and loss of life that the liberation of Europe entailed" so they're more tourist-open to it. In fact, they look at the war as a triumph of good vs evil, while the East looks at it as a dark memory.

Class Notes

In an attempt to include everyone, you've diminished parts of it. Including Communism and Nazism as the evils dilutes the "evil" sense.

Politics of Public History:

- When do we start caring for something? Why do we start caring for it?

Model for thesis writing.

Why do history? To take responsibility of the Holocaust? To use the Holocaust as a political narrative? History is not history.

Politics of Public History is the study on how to bring the nuance to these topics without losing the cohesion and significance – but also maintaining the public attention to it. How can you talk to this with tourists?

The Western front was less blood-thirsty than the Eastern front, so does that affect the narrative?

Some people want to divorce the past because it is uncomfortable.

Rough read, most important part is the part of the Museum that is halfway through the article.

Pre-Reading

- “settler colonialism is a structure, not an event, and that it is driven by the logic of elimination (of natives) rather than extraction of resources or exploitation of labor.”
- “Museumification” places things in the past when it’s not meant to be in the past, but in the present. It’s closing a book too soon.
- Comparison between the handling of settler colonialism of Australia-Indigenous and Israel-Palestinians. The former recognizes the past and includes them in the narrative of why Australia is the way it is, the latter silences it. Why?

Objections to Palestinians becoming “indigenous”

1. Becoming “indigenous” requires a freeze of their culture because it must be preserved as the past. Additionally, it requires orienting the past around tradition instead of their experience, the narrative is set by the settler.
2. They’re not used to it; they still hold their identity which has largely been anti-imperial for the recent past.
3. Would be an acquiescence of claim. They would give up claims for reparation and justice for inclusion.

“liberation movements constitute the only hope for the subjugated and the dispossessed to alleviate the extraordinary misery and human degradation which they have suffered.” Palestine remains a militant liberation movement that was never pressured (or allowed) to assimilate like other indigenous people.

The goal (indigenous politics) is questioning the legitimacy of the settler state’s framework while maintaining presence and political formations by indigenous people. Associating with the Palestinians right now means siding with these politics, whereas the Australian case is just a lukewarm acknowledgement with no further goals. Palestine is lighting a thousand fires, but the only fire lit for the Australian natives is the one lit by the settlers.

MUSEUM POLITICS:

Palestine museum went from a memory site to a “cultural empowerment” repository. It was built to be nodes focused on mass disperse of Palestinian culture and digitized so it wouldn’t be subject to looting and bombing.

- “the independence of the museum's program from any official political parties or governing bodies that might claim to represent or govern Palestinians are hallmarks

of the kind of alternative sovereignty that many say characterizes indigenous politics”

Canada’s solution to an indigenous boycott was:

- Increased involvement in interpretation of their cultures
- Repatriation of artifacts and human remains
- Improved access to museum collections

This transformed the land-based elimination claims to just cultural easily-accommodated ones. It missed the root issue. Palestine doesn’t suffer this.

Class Discussions

Lela – “The Author”, making a theoretical argument by using a case study with a less-organized paper compared to Monday. Do not write like this. When being told you need more secondary sources, add more because this is what happens where you shove an entire concept into one place without explaining it.

Mega footnotes are used to save thy ass, controversial topic with a major historiography. If it’s about the opposite side, include in “ya damn” essay. Only use to explain a context which might be relevant to considerations but not really addressed by the paper itself.

That it actually took sixteen months was surprising.

Reported that the repatriation of artifacts in Cambodia resulted in them not having a place even though it was rightfully there. “We’ll give you rando” – British Museum has things not in display that they’ll give back.

Heritagization (Pastification) – the act of turning something into something important.

Refer to the use of a term and its volume in ProQuest, that is a methodology of reviewing the Museum.

Pre-reading

The Humboldt Forum is a Prussian Royal Palace that many feared would be a “conservative indulgence in imperial nostalgia” of an awkward history.

Prussia was an imperialist power that history has tried to treat with a reductive image. The democratic Federal Republic had an interest to void this HD but for “good reason”? Yet the Humboldt didn’t resurrect these ideas.

Discussions mainly focused on “managing” the past in an authentic practice aligned with normal procedure. “I’m not interested in politics, but in aesthetics.” “We’re not rebuilding barracks, we’re reconstructing an artwork.” Other proponents asserted that the Prussian memory has already faded. It came at a time (East Germany GDR) when German aesthetics were unsatisfactory and that recreating the old Prussian palace would “serve as a bridge across the twentieth century, reconnecting the new Berlin Republic to a less taxing national heritage.”

“If destruction of the Palace [in 1950 by Communists] was to be a symbol of communism’s victory, reconstruction would be a symbol of its failure.” It was destroyed in the past because of wartime damage rendering it unusable and the German parliament put their building there but it was contaminated with asbestos. People countered the first sentence with this by saying that its hypocritical to attribute the first to politics (when it could also be building health) and not this second destruction. The Palast that occupied it was a memory site to communist dictatorship in a time of “dealing” with the communist past, but putting a Prussian palace in its place could be the same.

Using aesthetics in the discourse seemed to be avoiding the issue, but the Palast was genuinely found to be displeasing to citizens and so the issue went towards the Palance.

The debate, up until now, had been German-centric — but creating the Humboldt Forum allowed them to look outward by putting world culture history in the building. “If a national cultural and scientific forum is opened in this place where the Prussian Castle once stood, then Prussia could finally merge into Germany and Europe” (putting Prussia into contemporary world history by a “Prussian exterior and the “global” interior).

But housing colonial history (world history) in a building of a former colonial empire is a bad look, and it would get worse by incorporating a large Christian cross atop the building and an inscription of Prussian State-Christianity” which was not good Prussia. Proponents maintained the argument of aesthetics and authenticity. Would that work here?

Things would get worse for the supporters as many of the donors and fundings came from extreme far-right individuals.

Class Notes

Historian of Modern Germany, lived in Berlin.

1871: Berlin is capitol of Prussia, Imperial capitol of places in the Pacific.

1880: Germany abdicates and leaves the country to fragile Constitutional Republic.

1947: Nazi Reich and eventual split by the Allied Powers into East/West and Berlin East/West.

1990: Reunification of Germany moves to Berlin

Think of choices in a museum context: Preservation Reconstruction Absence makes the artifact work similarly if it no longer exists (or is degraded), or you can choose to make it absent. These are choices you can make, political choices.

Humboldt Forum is located in an area of other World-centric museums. Example of a preserved artifact of a Luf-Boot (boat used to travel to Pacific colonies). Why is it here though?

Background absent: The German Navy was sent in to punish the indigenous populations that were seen as lazy or unwilling to help. Luf sent these boats on the punitive missions. It was a sign of imperial power that struck fear into the hearts of indigenous whenever they saw these types of boats.

What would be the political obstructions to repatriating this artifact?

The Fascade of the building is privately funded. 1950s-70s, parade ground. East German gov't makes a Palast der Republik with architecture of "Soviet German" style.

Why do we accept reconstructions in some cases but demand the actual item in others?

Which artifacts should be... preserved? ...reconstructed? ...allowed to be absent?

If you see a Historian predicting the future, run away. They're usually wrong.

Battle of Berlin movie shooting at the Palace.

Pre-reading

Ethnography: Study of culture through observation, participation, immersion.

Post-ethnographic: Decentralize the importance of material objects and re-evaluate intangible African heritage.

Art museums and their ethnographic tendency of including Black art boils it down to just art made by someone with dark pigmentation instead of meaning behind the term. They exoticize the assimilation of the “Other” side. Museum of the “Us” instead of the “Other” for the “Normal” to view.

“The aim is to historicize the Black man instead of essentializing him.” “African man has not sufficiently become part of history... arguing that in Africa, there was place for neither human adventure nor the idea of progress.”

Black Civilizations (African) are living alongside the West in the present, so they have to find a place in History.

What is African History? Is it just centered on its subjugation by Europe? Or more?

“Bocoum argued that the claim for the restitution of looted objects was not ‘his fight,’ but rather belonged to the ‘political sphere.’” (page 44). The objects held in exile place “specific emotions” that are “potentially affecting the future audience of the museum.” Next sentence: traditional museums are just “incarnations of colonial exhibitions” that have “radiated an aura of melancholy.” Instead, focus on temporary lively exhibits as opposed to permanent fixed ones.

Art is the process of thought gained from the exhibit, instead of just object-based.

African heritage as going beyond memory sites but interaction with the site in humanity. Challenges of this approach:

- Placing a difference between African and Western may place you into the dichotomous view of culture.
- Making a post colonial future while staying outside the dichotomy of cultures is difficult.
- Museums are inherently symbols of West and so is its discourses. They are “inextricably tied with discourses that have historically sought to undermine, or

render mute, the possibility of any kind of African subjectivity in matters dealing with archival or musicological knowledge.”

“Emptiness, portrayed as painful legacy of the colonial past, becomes in the context of the MCN, a unique opportunity to shape the inner space” – “Space is here perceived as an active participant in this dialogue”

What are the dangers of “restoring a history”?

- An ethnographic view of “us studying them” instead of “we studying each other”.
- Pushing the “individual” out of heritage: UNESCO takes an island despite its use. Also has certain requirements which are hard to maintain for locals.
-

What should you think about when you are “restoring” a narrative?

- Do you want to proceed with a focus on “objects” or the “living” of the narrative?

- How are you going to have different cultures interact with each other? Do not exoticize the others.

Discussion Notes

Who belongs to “Africa” and “African art” – look in terms of nationalism.

What makes a museum? Artifacts? Clearly not in this case.

Repatriation is a colonial construct. The museum in Dakar has a collection of artifacts themselves from areas of “West Africa” that they don’t know where to repatriate to or how. If they decentralize the artifacts themselves, they don’t have to repatriate them because fuck artifacts.

If you freeze art as a relic and place it in the past, it will never live. The point of this museum is an authentic experience of stories, living history, etc.

Canonization of art is an example of AHD. It is decided by the standards set in a European context. Example: UNESCO sites are based on the standards of the UN which is largely agreed by countries and Europeanization.

EU: A selective understanding of 19th century liberalism.

European thinking of time is a flat timeline but locals are experiencing a more living dynamic history. Therefore, a European spectator is privileged in this handling of history.

Dangers of restoring a narrative.

- Restoration is artifact and object-based so we should go with the MCN approach
- Or that repatriation is a problem for not just colonizers like with the West African collection that they don’t know how to begin repatriation.
- Can it be both?

Question: unanswered. Could be both, don’t know how. Assess other museums for the same thing.

Pre-reading

Rebecca Lenihan

What does Lenihan suggest is the public good of academic history?

Is academic history different from public? Should it be?

Class Discussion Notes

How do you maintain the narrative of the heritage discourse if you democratize and make the heritage more easily accessible by digitization.

Generation or an experience thing?

Is it a sale of memory or heritage? Is heritage memory?

Chew on this: Heritage is not objects or sites, it is a process of consumable experience.

- Heritage is multitemporal: it is existing in a past, present, and future.
- It is polyvocal, there are multiple voices involved in it.
- It is plural, there are multiple heritages simultaneously existing.

Therefore, it is dissonant. It clashes and fights each other, and it is intentional. There is a difference between Heritage interpretation and Heritage preservation. Ashcroft is known for this theory.

Dahlonge: the square is a heritage site and people are profiting off it. What are they selling? Heritage? Vibes? Is heritage consistent of vibes?

We turn the past into a commodity.

Money is usually a good “so what?”

Class Notes

Use the Mississippi State University archive for the reflection assignment.

Review funding and where the archives come from.

Trade agreements are a form of debt coercion — investigate.

Payment for the gaining of artifacts. United States became less generous in visa granting after 9/11, letting the wealthy in South Africa to see collections of Western “proper culture” without having to go through visa. Same thing for franchised Universities, letting students attend without actually coming here.

- Museums get money.
- States get the “good will”
 - Serves as a way to cool diplomatic tensions. A pressure release valve.

Disney week. Friday guest lectures. Do the reading.

Politics of Public History — (3/3/2025)

Main Street and the Larsen Museum of Appalachia article. Also, it's an artificial site of memory caused by the acceleration of history from the Nora article.

Nostalgia's goal is to return to a "socially less conflicted, less ethnic" time. In Gieringer's view, the "traditional town" was being "torn apart by two world wars and a great depression."

The origin of separating space from contemporary time began in Scandinavia.

Men (Ford, Rockefeller, Grienger) who immersed themselves in technological advances sought escapism — the more someone who surrounded by this, the more they seek "peace" through nostalgia. But nostalgia requires contradiction: Ford's Greenfield Village glorified Edison and inventions of the past (technological progressivism) that led to the circumstances which made Ford want to escape.

Disneyland Main Street is the McKinley America frozen into a single spot, with its shops of American labor and teeming with consumerism.

Main Street "requires total obedience to the designers's dream of a public utopia. That is, no changes can be made in the original conception without compromising the whole: if wooden fences look right, look old-fashioned, in the desired way, then white plastic fences (more durable, but after all plastic and shiny) must be forbidden."

"Because they were built at one moment, they have not had the luxury, one might say, of evolving a more layered, more organic appearance that would allow for variation. They are hyper-realities, not realities."

Class Notes

Wednesday's reading is a little long, take time with it. Today is a bridge to another day.

Guest speaker for Friday is a politically charged historian

Rockefeller and Ford come from the progressive era that tried to "cure" the world with a base of middle-class whiteness.

Class Notes

- **BACKGROUND:** Walt had a strong vision for Disney but after he died, the corporation struggled to interpret what “Wal would’ve wanted”
- Jungle Cruse was a “cruise through Africa” and there were natives. It’s pretty racist, slightly rehabilitated.
- Is it possible to have a “true” history into a commodity.

Class Notes

Research on Choice Street Church — Dahlonaga, GA.

Levels of Public History:

- State/Local — **Abundant**
 - SHPOs, Historic Districts, Museums, Libraries
 - Home Story: making stories for historic homes
- National
 - NPS, National Register of Historic Places
- International
 - UNESCO World Heritage Sites
 - Recommend at least looking through the list.
 - Which ones are in peril?

Public History needs engagement and people wanting to talk about it. If you notice a place in need, you can go and help out.

The needs of Public History:

- What kind of history interests you?
- What kind of work do you want to do? (public or behind the scenes?)
 - Archives? Museum? Etc?
- What stories need to be told?
 - Things, places, inventors, etc.
- What stories do you want to be a part of?
- What are others researching?
- Who is hiring?

History – Art History — Public Engagement

“Staying in our academic bubble is not what we should be doing right now.”

Thesis trenches: what story do you want to tell?

- What has not been said?
- What hasn't been articulated correctly?
- What needs to be done further?

You can make the decision to give the story up or to become part of a story.

“What do you want me to talk about?”

You don’t have to sugarcoat but it can still have a great positive image?

“How do you go from visitor to employee?”

Museums are slowly realizing that exhibits and tactile experience matters, so they’re going to look for this if they’re a good museum. They have needs, you have skills.

Investigate other sources a layer removed if you have deletion or archive problems.

Smaller museums don’t get passes.

Museum inventory affects the adoration of a museum.

Master’s Program:

- Tiring
- Different: Less classes but more work
- Five assignments at once but they require every single brain cell.
 - Looming research project that your professor will never bring up but will be due at the end of the semester.
 - Assistantship is like a full time job on top of your school work. Tuition waiver and a good stipend depending on your school and job.
- Fun trauma-bonding

Undergrad?

- Would’ve described it as tiring but it’s nothing compared to a master program.
- As a TA, has to grade assignments. Social life too.

How did you choose? Had mixed feelings. If you get in, go. If not, oh well!

Politics of Public History — (3/17/2025)

Terms can develop perjorative meanings based on politics which leaves out the factual matter.

The process of becoming a state is whether something “feels American” which is dogwhistle for whiteness. We take Mexico land but have to flood white people in.

KKK takes a special light in Wilson’s history. “Very cool, Wilson!”

Native American.

Class Notes

Meet 1:45 PM in the parking lot of the museum. This Friday is the ARC and also we’re going to meet at the picnic square for Friday class, stay tuned for that. Fern Bank.

The scramble for Africa is used as the referent of colonialism but Matthew argues that there needs to be a rethinking of the referent.

Book: “How to Hide an Empire”

Easier to contemplate bad in a not-United States context — is that an indictment of ourselves and Americanization of our mind even in academic context?

Before break is harkening to a period of when we were an empire.

Pre-Reading

How can museums and public historians acknowledge migrations and the idea that humans are not just from one place?

- Malaysia National Museum studies just Malay evolutionary history and cuts off other groups like Chinese and Indians (smaller voices) despite making up nearly half the pop. This is necessary for nation building.
- Migration is absent in the Thai and Malaysian museum. Implicit assumption is that these people always occupied the land, which is not true.
- Vietnam's History Museum is mono-ethnic, Vietnam Museum of Ethnology is multi-ethnic.
- Past examples of ignoring the geo-body in history, but the closer to the present the more national a national history museum gets.
- The only time there is mention of the "outside" is European colonial expansion.
- Also there's the "here's a map of what we once were" and the implicit assumption is that we should go back to that because more land is gooder.

How can you bring this idea to your research?

- Text

Other Thoughts:

- Cartography as a form of power and drawing boundaries around subjects and nations for senses of order. Page 58.
- Maps that place the nation into perspective are common but not valued in exhibits.

Pre-reading

What does Beetham say about the context of Confederate monuments?

Monuments are, ironically, not set in stone and “adapt to ever-shifting circumstances in fluctuating landscapes.” (91) Sometimes they move because of accidents or municipal construction projects — parallel with the German asbestos-ridden museum.

What are the controversies associated?

The presence of the statute, typically near seats of gov’t, were used to terrorize and mark land as belonging to White Supremacists.

Why or how might they be relocated?

The solution is more car accidents and sleepy police officers.

Local problems require local solutions within the community. There can’t be a state or national discussion, each city is different.

- Documenting the existing memorial landscape
- Advocating for solutions for controversial monuments
- Proposing new uses for public space that engage with underrepresented communities or histories

“Destruction of monuments in the context of the 2020 police brutality protests should be seen as a total rejection of efforts by individual states to wrest control of public space away from the people.” — Hypocritical that the discussion is away from community instead to mob rule?

Class Notes

Meeting at the cemetery on Monday.

Politics of Public History — (3/25/2025)

Prereading

- “Monuments aren’t history lessons—they’re pledges of allegiance. As the story of *Freedom* reminds us, monuments are created and controlled by powerful people to advance their own interests. Monuments present a specific version of history, without room for doubts or questions.”

What is Thompson’s argument about Stone Mountain?

- Stone Mountain isn’t old to be history, and it’s not even an authentic white supremacist sign according to their own standards.
- Harder to recontextualize. Putting in a museum alone doesn’t extract the hateful message. Place in an area that spark discourse about the aura of it.
 - Fredrick Douglass bad ass statue is a recontextualization.
- Monuments aren’t always put up in a democratic way, but their removal should be democratic after looking at their history which is not at all difficult to do.

What does she argue is the mission of the Stone Mountain monument?

- “began as a pet project of the KKK and ended as a way for Georgia’s governor to signal his resistance to school integration.”
- KKK founded on Stone Mountain, Mount Rushmore creator was member. He’s in debt and gets a call to make Stone Mountain carving. KKK dues become a pyramid scheme which also helped him.

How does the lifecycle of the monument and its political context reflect a real or fictitious past?

- Politics can literally void a past. Stone Mountain was just a sleazy project for money with little authenticity, but now it is treated as one.
- Memorial: don’t repeat. Monument: repeat, they’re about the future (HERITAGE). Respect the heritage of Confederacy even if it’s not yours because it fought against the “hideous specter” of racial equality.
- Confederate legacy vs. Shrimp shit.

Class Notes

The land of Stone Mountain used to be a prison camp occupied by mostly African American, making it cheaper just because of their presence.

Monuments are for the future.

Pre-reading Notes

What is the role of contemporary politics in these materials?

- Southern heritage, understood as Nora puts it, is being used for the future by pulling from the past. These monuments are the lieux de memoire that embody that heritage used for contemporary politics.
- Political life — Stone Mountain for the Georgia Governor against school segregation.

How does or does not the difficult history affect the authors' ideas?

- “regional heritage and pride” why? Is it heritage in the sense of Nora says, that we use it for the future?

Class Notes

No cemetery class on Monday — it gon' rain.

Bring some sort of device that can access the internet. Computer is probably better, we're going to be working with the database with ancestry.com. Can reflect on ancestry.com or on the cemetery, assignment will be changed to reflect that.

Email Allison.

Ingredients to a race conversation:

- Local discussion
- When the statue was put up
- Demographics of the school
- Donors
 - Financial damages to taking down a racial icon
 - Scholarships give interest not the principle, which is why it stays for so long

“Do we have to? Everyday?” Attack the big fish?

“The most important element of creating nationalism and identity is the forgetting of history. The selective remembering and the selective forgetting.”

Monuments are built to be taken down. They're put up in public areas to be provocative

Politics of Public History – (4/2/2025)

Philanthropy & Grace in the Haitian Revolution

- Thought that all white people adhered to slavery, researched into the contours.
 - Investigates slavery and university ties, transitioned from Haitian Revolution during COVID because archive restrictions.
 - Worked on a project in unmarked graves to do identification work.
-
- Communication practices through burial practices. “This group leaves the dead up high and exposed to the elements, this group does singing, etc.”
-
- Slave cemeteries are usually not registered with the state records or cared for.
 - A space outside of town.
 - Secluded graves with no markers
 - DO NOT REMOVE ANYTHING FROM A GRAVESITE: GRAVE GOODS. Use empathy when entering a burial site. Would you want someone taking something from your grave? Just East to West orientation is religious enough.
 - Usually they’re outside towns but sometimes towns grow.
 - Look for difference in vegetation, sometimes that’s a marker in itself that means something. If you’re struggling to read a headstone, use the mirror trick. Google it.
-
- Portion of Arlington cemetery with variation, even though it’s a national cemetery. Sometimes they don’t start as state cemeteries, they eventually get that designation.
-
- Legally need consent from family, if it’s unmarked then you can’t do that. Also, what if that person’s group doesn’t want that? NAGPRA (Native American Grave Repatriation Act) is when an indigenous grave needs to be moved and repatriated to a native American group.
 - KJ brings up the point about how African Americans have different treatments with Native Americans: group cohesion?
 - Slave Schedule: U.S. Census in some places.
 - Some places have acidic soil that eat away the

Politics of Public History — (4/7/2025)

- Project Types
 - Projects (heritage homes, sites, etc)
 - Local histories (family, people, etc)
 - Blogs
 - Education promotion
 - Historiography, Primary Source Workshops
 - Museum sites themselves
 - Commemoration and chronicling
- Levels
 - Mostly national, then international, then local, then regional.
- Languages
 - Mostly English, almost entirely English
- Activities
 - Audio tours
 - Visit monuments
 - Regional and locals
 - On site activities for local communities/Community-related events
 - Sharing and preserving community collections (Banks of memory)
 - Putting their name in the community as opposed to reverse
- Elements
 - Creation of content
 - Publication and ability to comment
 - Manipulation and remixing of content
- “Greater equality between museum and the user” as a potential threat.

Last few weeks are engaging in history besides research papers.

Social media prioritizes the easy history because the bad stuff will get punished by algorithms.

What

Blue Ridge Rifles Visit with Allison

Originals are possibly in the public library in the Madelaine Anthony collection. Not listed on the Finding Aid because they're copies and not originals.

The Dahlongega Boys by Fannie Boyd:

- “When first the South aroused her sons
To deeds of fame and might
They left their own fair mountain homes
To battle for the right.”

North Georgia Journal — A quarterly genealogy-history magazine: Dr. Dorothy Brown was involved in naming the Blue Ridge Rifles. Why?

- “because of the previous unity in the (something) and the applicability to the campus situation.” — Written in the 80s — President Hoag was delighted.
- Original composition was Charles R. Moore as Captain (MOORE WAS GRANDSON OF Charles M. Moore)
 - Wesley Earley: First Lieutenant; Forrest J. Sisk, Second Lieutenant. Jack Drennan, Captain's Aide.
- “the men chose the Rifles because this unit mustered early in the war and served continuously for the duration.”
 - They served under Longstreet — likely in Chickamauga because that is when he had the most Georgia forces.
 - The Atlanta Journal Constitution: December 10, 1959
- The Dahlongega Nugget: January 13, 1961. Article on the Mustering Grounds marker that I brought up to Dr. Hightower in class. It was used as grounds for mustering troops for the Mexican-American war and removal of the Indians from North Georgia, as well as other skirmishes.
- The Daily Times (Gainesville, GA) January 9, 1961: celebration on Dahlongega square on election of delegates to secession congress. The delegate was son-in-law of Colonel Price, and father of Captain Joseph Hamilton who organized the original Blue Ridge Rifles.
- Article written by “David Ralston” (would've been 22 at this time, maybe) on Augustus Boyd's letters from the war. Referred to it as the War Between the States. Article is for The Times (Gainesville, GA) on July 4, 1976.
- Officially known as Colonel William Phillips' Company E and was present at the surrender at Appomattox.

- Honor ceremony involving the College BRR on April 26, 1986 to honor the original BRR veterans buried in Mount Hope.
- 1969: New BRR wore greys to signify the old rebel uniform.

Politics of Public History — (4/9/2025)

Digital History: the middle ground between public and academic history. Also helps with curated lists and bibliographies to provide quality secondary sources — but they're not public because they're not free, the list is free though.

Class Notes

Field Specialty: U.S. Historian, the long 20th century: post civil war to present. 1870 to 1942. Digital Historian. Personal projects revolve around gender conveyed, normed, and explained in the way we define criminal behavior.

Scholars don't make it less confusing, they get locked in a rabbit hole of definitions. It really doesn't matter. Digital is a tool, it's not a field *per se*.

Digital History— “An approach to examining, analyzing, and representing the past that uses digital tools and technologies to help us ask historical questions and answer those questions with evidence.”

- The last part is core to history, but digital can help us ask better or new questions
- Can also deal with things we've never deal with before.
- Can include publishing

How do we use these tools?

- Presentation to give more impact than what is possible in a written form.
 - Can explain the history of the KKK, how it evolved, and how it became a culture... but also can just show a map.
 - “Where there are Americans, there's a Klan.”
 - Does it make the presentation better? If not, it's not worth it. You don't have to use digital history. It's a tool, not a religion.
 - You can also embed digital history into analog history.
 - “Well everyone writes history with a computer so everything is digital?”
 - You can make that argument but it's dumb because it is not digital in presentation. It's just analog on a computer.
- Digital History can go beyond what we have to identify trends or patterns to be used as an explore directions to ask new questions, better questions, or open a whole new line of research.
 - Data from the U.S. Labor Board on the demographic breakdown of individuals.
 - Your brain can't do anything with that. It'll take you a long time and you may even do it wrong.
 - Computer can do it better. You take the data, translate to digital, and ask the computer to organize and do it yourself.

Dr. Bush's new book research.

- Looked into records of every female that entered a reformatory in a certain time. She has photographs of these records.
- She organized the data into an Excel and ran some formulas on it. Previously, Historians believed that most of juvenile reformatory commits came from Urban areas, her data (when compiled) showed the opposite.

“Affect” — Playing on digital mental state.

You are conveying specialized historical knowledge to an audience. Keep It Simple, Stupid (KISS) principle.

- Can you assume your audience has specialized knowledge?
 - Yes, then you are doing “academic” history.
 - No, then you are probably doing “public” history.
- For either of these audiences, is there something best shared in a visual medium?
- For either of these audiences, is there something that you need to learn to share your specialized knowledge that might be best learned with digital technology.

Digital is about the tool — Public is about the audience.

90s: Communication & Collaboration — Listservs, Emails. Historians in Europe can talk to Historians in United States. It didn't touch Public History yet.

Websites and Collections — FindingAids, Exhibits, films, essays, teaching resources, discussion boards/forums, brochureware.

Democratized Publishing Platforms & Tools — Wordpress, Omeka, Scalar, GitHub, Jupyter, ORCID, Zenodo, Zotero, ManyEyes, Gephi, Palladio, Tableau, Datawrapper, TimelineJS, Storymap, ARCGIS

3D Simulations & Virtual Reality — Audio-visual recreations based on a lot of data and a lot of programming, widely available and institutionally available.

Now: Data-driven Computational & Geospatial History — Big data, widely available analysis tools, proliferation of data and programming.

YouTube is an archive — John.

HitlerMuseum.org — Looked like a real history group, not really.

An abundance model: lots more sources and so we're in a new era where "history" is too much.

Always use a citation and a caption. Every image should have an argument.

Politics of Public History — (4/21/2025)

“Why museums are returning cultural treasures”

- “Museumification” with the Australian aboriginals and Palestinians from some weeks ago.
- Repatriation is a process that can bring better relationships than just having the items themselves.
- “We give all objects to the world.” — French
- Displays are 1% of what is actually possessed.

Saturday will be a tough day for traffic: multiple events in Dahlonga.

This Friday at 3:30 PM, we meet at the cemetery.

Gallery walk: Planned for 25, but really just 15. Next week reserved for this. Think and come in on Wednesday with ideas.

Reliance on markers and bad notes creates a problem of “who do we give the items to?” And also a problem of giving the items to public or private collectors.

Who’s taking the thing and what value do they assign to the thing?

A lot of this communication is between states and not groups within the states. Do we have a responsibility to communicate with those groups? If so, who is the leader?

Museums rebut by saying that they steal the items to give it to “the world.” The only eyes that can see it is from this socioeconomic class, not the actual eyes who were owners of it.

What is the hierarchy of the museum’s holdings? Who determines the hierarchy?

Politics of Public History — (4/22/2025)

Who should oversee policing this? Is it criminal or cultural offense?

How does wartime affect cultural heritage?

- Private collectors ignore warnings from attorneys (Hobby Lobby). The items were not purchased from ISIS. Focusing on ISIS reduces the problem to just terror groups when it also involves governments and private groups.
 - The state has a normal history of corruption when it comes to these cases.
 - Looting and purchase requires items to be removed from their context, which completely destroys the academic value.
 - Scholars that work and value these items that have been stolen provide positive reinforcement to this system.
 - Turning a blind-eye becomes a weapon of a state for political motivations: Turkey letting the illegal artifact trade through their borders that affects Syria's occupation by the Islamic State.
 - Heritage and history are state-building tools as we have discussed before. In this case, IS stakes its claim by bulldozing history just because it can.
-
- **There is cultural museumification on one side, politicized theft of history permissible by state/academics, and the flat out destruction/cleansing of history on the other. The entire process shows the role of history and History in state-building.**

Class Notes

- Do the class evaluations because they help in the future design of other classes, especially since this is an upper division class. The writing side is most important, but do both sides. The numbers are useful for the Sith Lord award.

Politics of Public History — (4/25/2025)

Meet at 3:15 at the front entrance near Johnny B's.

NAGPRA and what do we do with the stuff that we find. Who owns the stuff that gets dug up?

Ethnohistorian. Worked in cultural resources after graduation.

- Passed in 1990.
- Things that got us here
 - 1987 Looting of Slack (?) Farm Kentucky, where three states come together. Late Mississippian site, early 1600s. Seven cemeteries there, well known to be well-protected. Patriarch passes away and then it gets sub-leased out to a tenant farmer who then gave permission to a dig for \$10k. Police called and then seized as much as they could to protect but some items taken and sold across state lines. Bits of humans everywhere.
- Requirements—
 - Applies to museums, agencies, and anyone that uses or takes federal money.
 - Compile detailed summaries of inventories: do we have human remains? Artifacts?
 - Consult with Native American tribes with follow ups for repatriation
 - Human Remains
 - Culturally Related: We know which culture according to federally recognized tribes.
 - Not Culturally Related: We don't know which culture because they're possibly older than the historic period or we don't have a direct lineal (colonizing records) group.
 - Funerary Objects
 - Did it come from a grave? Was it an item that came alongside a skeleton?
 - Some cases where the skeleton is separated from the item.
 - Sacred Items
 - Ceremonial objects: "Items needed by traditional Native American leaders for traditional Native American religion ceremonies."
 - So, no ceremony = no protection?

- What's going on right now in museums?
 - Department of Interior gave guidance on NAGPRA, which required organizations to work with these tribes. There was a loophole that allowed them to keep items that are culturally “unidentifiable”. It is compelling those that are under NAGPRA to consider lines of descent.

Native Hawaiians and Native Americans: but not Polynesians or groups in places like American Samoa, Guam, Marshall Islands, Puerto Rico (no federally recognized tribes here). They are excluded.

Politics of Public History – (5/2/2025)

Place the project in the dropbox and then come into the gallery walk ready for questions.
Insert into Project Dropbox.

Noah Bryant: graduated 2021. Company worked for GDOT to do projects. “The Stitch”

A law of documentation, not protection. Can’t stop a project that threatens these places.
Sometimes it’s cheaper to excavate a site than move a project (like a new roadway).

In Wales, he worked on 3D modeling historic items in the university’s possession. Tried to 3D print them but ran into grant issues – wasn’t related to the purpose.

Used Agisoft Metashape (?) MeshRoom (free, open source)

If you own the land, you do whatever to it.